Type 1: Research Project | Phase 1 Review 2

# Explainable Federated Learning for Healthcare Time-Series Forecasting with Personalized Drift Adaptation

**Team Number: 28**

| S.No | Register Number | Student Name |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | CB.SC.U4CSE23363 | Haswitha K |
| 2 | CB.SC.U4CSE23529 | Hasini Reddy M |
| 3 | CB.SC.U4CSE23547 | Sheela Akshar Sakhi |
| 4 | CB.SC.U4CSE23761 | Kousik Sarma Lakkaraju |
| 5 | CB.SC.U4CSE23753 | V.Chakravarthy |

Guide: **Dr. G R RAMYA, Dr. VANDHANA S**

Department of CSE

# Project Proposal and Objectives

**Overall Project Idea:** To design a completely decentralized, **Federated Personalized Drift-Aware Attention Framework (FPDAF)** tailored specifically for Multivariate Healthcare Time-Series (e.g., predicting ICU risks like Sepsis from patient vitals).

## Objectives to Achieve

1. **Privacy Preservation:** Train predictive models across multiple hospitals collaboratively without sharing raw patient data (Federated Learning).
2. **Personalization:** Use Local Personalization Heads to manage patient heterogeneity (Non-IID distributions).
3. **Drift Adaptation:** Implement CUSUM algorithms to detect when a patient's physiological state degrades and rapidly adapt the model locally.
4. **Clinical Trust:** Provide transparency using Temporal Attention mechanisms so doctors know *why* the model predicted a risk.

# Introduction and Background

**Introduction to the Problem:** In modern Intensive Care Units (ICUs), continuous monitoring systems generate vast amounts of high-frequency multivariate time-series data (Heart Rate, Blood Pressure, SpO2). Detecting critical deterioration early saves lives.

**Motivation to Solve This Specific Problem:**

- **The Data Silo Problem:** High-accuracy Deep Learning models require massive datasets, but rigid healthcare privacy laws (e.g., HIPAA) forbid combining data into a centralized server.
- **The Global Model Failure:** If multiple hospitals successfully engage in standard Federated Learning (FedAvg), the resulting "global model" fails because hospital demographics and local treatment protocols vary wildly.
- **The Black Box Problem:** Doctors cannot act on an AI alert if the model cannot explain the physiological basis for its warning.

# Research Gap Analysis

| Existing Research | Identified Limitations / Gap | Need / Why Gap Matters | Project Contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Centralized ML and on-device analytics systems (Papers 1, 17, 19, 23) | Do not support federated learning or privacy-preserving collaboration | Centralized data sharing violates privacy laws and is unsuitable for distributed environments | Enables collaborative analytics using federated learning without sharing raw data |
| Basic Federated Learning frameworks (FedAvg) (Papers 2, 4, 5) | Lack personalization, explainability, and analytics-level insights | A single global model performs poorly on heterogeneous client data | Introduces personalized local models with global aggregation and analytics |
| Personalized Federated Learning methods (FedPer, pFL) (Papers 3, 10, 16, 20) | Personalization exists but lacks explainability and drift awareness | Without explainability and adaptation, predictions cannot be trusted over time | Combines personalization with explainable analytics and drift handling |
| Concept driftaware FL approaches (Papers 2, 9) | Drift handling is not integrated with analytics or forecasting pipelines | Real-world data behavior changes over time, degrading prediction accuracy | Integrates drift detection with time-series analytics and forecasting |
| Federated Time-Series Forecasting works (Papers 6, 8, 1015, 18) | Primarily focus on accuracy; limited explainability and personalization | Stakeholders require transparency to trust and act on predictions | Provides explainable insights alongside federated forecasting |
| Explainable AI approaches (Papers 7, 17, 19, 23) | Explainability mostly exists in centralized or non-time-series settings | Explainability is critical for trust in sensitive domains like healthcare and energy | Adapts explainable AI techniques to federated time-series analytics |
| Healthcare-focused FL applications (Papers 9, 21, 22, 24, 25) | Application-specific solutions with limited generalization | A reusable framework is required across multiple domains | Proposes a domain-agnostic federated analytics framework |
| Security- and privacy-enhanced FL methods (Papers 13, 24, 25) | High complexity and low usability despite strong privacy guarantees | Practical systems must balance privacy, performance, and usability | Balances privacy, efficiency, and interpretability in a single framework |

# Dataset: PhysioNet Challenge 2019 (Sepsis Prediction)

**Dataset Overview:**

- **Source:** PhysioNet (Public Healthcare Dataset).
- **Data Type:** Real-world multivariate ICU patient monitoring time-series.
- **Structure:** 40,000 patient files (`.psv`), with each row representing one hourly observation.
- **Key Features:** Heart Rate, BP, SpO2, Temperature, ICULOS.
- **Target:** `SepsisLabel` (predicting deterioration).

**Why PhysioNet?**

- **Heterogeneity:** `setA` & `setB` come from different hospitals (perfect for FL).
- **Time-Series:** Sequences support LSTM & Drift tracking.
- **Clinical:** Interpretable vitals support our XAI mechanism.

# Execution Plan (Components & Flow)

| Subdomain | Matching Components Identified | Execution Target |
|---|---|---|
| **Data Engineering** | PhysioNet Sepsis Database, Time-series normalization, Sequential chunking. | Preprocessing Pipeline |
| **Deep Learning Base** | LSTM/Transformer backbone, Temporal Attention Layer. | Global Model |
| **Decentralization** | Federated Averaging (FedAvg) algorithm, Secure Gradient Aggregation. | Federated Loop |
| **Customization** | Local Personalization Heads (*FedPer*). | Client Local Model |
| **Statistical Math** | Cumulative Sum (CUSUM) for tracking prediction residual drift. | Drift Tracker Module |

**Solution Pipeline:** Extract Data $\rightarrow$ Train Local Models $\rightarrow$ Identify Attention Metrics $\rightarrow$ Sync Shared Layers Globally $\rightarrow$ Monitor Sub-populations for Drift $\rightarrow$ Adapt Local Heads.

# Fundamentals Learned in the Semester

To execute the plan above, our team embarked on extensive upskilling over this semester:

- **Federated Learning Architecture:** Extensively reviewed *McMahan et al.'s* fundamental papers to understand gradient averaging and the shift from Centralized ML to Decentralized ML.
- **PyTorch Framework Fundamentals:** Completed MOOCs & online tutorials to transition our team's technical skills into PyTorch (specifically custom `nn.Module` networks, `DataLoaders`, and customized training loops).
- **Time-Series Analytics:** Studied LSTM sequence modeling and Attention-mechanism math (computing context vectors via softmax weights).
- **Statistical Process Control:** Learned the *CUSUM* (Cumulative Sum) statistical methodology for detecting small shifts in ongoing time-series data.

# Mathematical Foundation

## 1. Standard Federated Averaging (FedAvg Base):

$$w_{t+1} = \sum_{k=1}^{K} \frac{n_k}{n} w_{t+1}^k \tag{1}$$

- Server aggregates weights $w_{t+1}^k$ from $K$ hospitals weighted by patient count $n_k$. (Personalization heads are strictly excluded from this sum).

## 2. CUSUM Drift Detection (Client-Side Trigger):

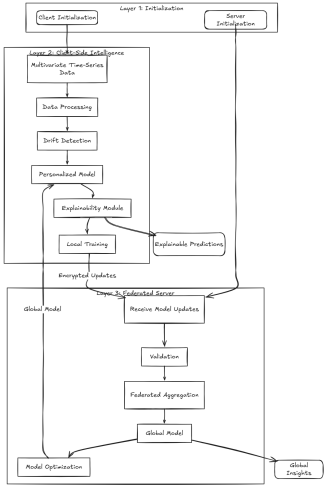
$$S_t = \max(0, S_{t-1} + (e_t - \mu - k)) \tag{2}$$

- $e_t$: Prediction error (residual) at time step $t$.
- $\mu$: Mean error during stable conditions.
- If the cumulative statistic $S_t > H$ (Threshold), a concept drift is flagged, triggering local model retraining.

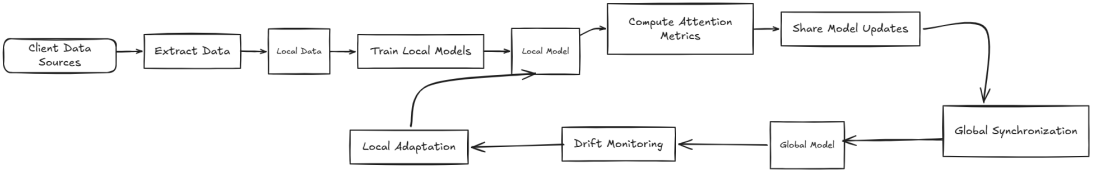
# Architecture Diagram and Explanation of Design

## Why this design?

- **Privacy:** Only encrypted gradients travel upward.
- **Local LSTM Base:** Captures generalized physiological rules.
- **Attention Layer:** Provides XAI (feature importance) right before the local prediction.
- **Personalization Head:** NEVER shared with the server. Tailors risk predictions to the specific local patient cohort.



# System Dataflow Mapping



# Summary of Works Completed (Technical Evidence)

**Phase 1 Contributions mapping to Technical Validation & Evidence:**

1. **Problem Formulation:** Successfully scoped the application domain specifically to healthcare ICU telemetry.
2. **Mathematical Formulation:** Defined formulas for exactly how CUSUM and Attention will be mathematically integrated into the *FedPer* pipeline.
3. **Architecture Design:** Finalized the multi-layered system diagram.
4. **Repository Framework Setup (Baseline Code):**
   - Initialized project GitHub repository.
   - Pulled and set up the foundational **FedAvg-PyTorch base framework**.
   - Built initial custom PyTorch stubs simulating the isolated ‘LocalPersonalizedModel‘ and a synthetic ‘SimulatedICUDataset‘ proxy.

# Plans for the Oncoming Semesters (Phase 2)

**The direct roadmap to full implementation:**

| **Target Area** | **Objective for Phase 2** |
|---|---|
| **Dataset Setup** | Download and process the full PhysioNet 2019 ICU Time-Series database. |
| **Baseline Benchmarking** | Train standard *FedAvg* on PyTorch to establish RMSE/MAE baselines. |
| **Sub-Model Integration** | Code the *CUSUM* mathematical trigger and the *Attention* weight visualizer. |
| **Simulation Runs** | Simulate 3-5 distinct Hospital "Clients" locally to monitor Federated convergence. |
| **Final Evaluation** | Quantify percentage gains in accuracy and personalization against baselines. |

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**Thank You** Questions?